

of running the Mac operating system, Apple would take a huge hit. Therefore, he bought out Power Computing's Mac OS license and made the operating system the exclusive property of Apple again. He brought a lot of culture back into Apple—the culture of creativity, innovation, and classy design that the company had thrived on in its early days. Huge Apple billboards, containing the simple message “Think Different” were soon visible across the United States announcing it to the world at large that Apple was back.

1.4 “We’re Profitable”

Jobs appeared onstage at Macworld, 1998 and gave his traditional lengthy but absorbing speech. At the very end, pretending he had finished but then returning to the microphone, he added as if just a footnote, “I almost forgot. We’re profitable.” The crowd cheered the announcement and loved Steve Jobs, the saviour of Apple. But the fact was slightly different. Almost the entire credit for the turnaround in Apple’s fate was deserved by Gil Amelio. But he was already forgotten and Jobs was once again basking in someone else’s glory.

Championed by Jobs, Apple launched the first iMac on May 6, 1998. By integrating the monitor into the same box as all the circuits, modems and plugs, he had gone back to the days of the early Macintosh and created a consumer-computing appliance in one unit. Open the box, plug it in, and get started. The iMac was the first computer that shipped with a CD-ROM instead of a floppy drive. It was instrumental in driving the old and practically useless floppy drive technology out of the market and bringing in the newer, more advanced technology of compact discs. The iMac took off in the market and started raking in healthy profits for Apple.

Jobs also chopped off the Newton from the company’s line-up, just when the product had started bringing in some profits and had been proven to be the most advanced PDA in the market. It is